17.8 Meningitis in Children*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says, "He is very irritable and vomiting." **Objective** • Infant: bulging fontanelle, high-pitched cry • Temperature 39 °C • Feeding poorly	**ACTUAL** Impaired infant neurodevelopmental organization related to meningeal inflammation as evidenced by irritability, a high-pitched cry and a bulging fontanelle.	• Neurological status stable.	• Give IV antibiotics without delay, as prescribed. • Watch consciousness, the fontanelle and head circumference. • Keep the room quiet and dim.	• Goal reached while he remains stable.
Subjective • Mother says, "He is very hot." **Objective** • Temperature 39 °C • Flushed	**ACTUAL** Hyperthermia related to infection as evidenced by fever.	• Afebrile within 48 hours.	• Give weight-based antipyretics. • Follow temperature. • Keep him hydrated.	• Met once afebrile.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Bacterial meningitis	**RISK** Risk for infection [transmission to others] as evidenced by risk factors: droplet transmission.	• No spread to contacts.	• Use droplet precautions per policy. • Inform infection control. • Arrange prophylaxis for contacts as ordered.	• Achieved if no spread occurs.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [38], [104], [117]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.